

Onotsavam Quiz Buzzer

Setup guide for the host

Teams buzz in from their own phones, and you get the full order they buzzed in.

Only your laptop needs anything installed. Everyone playing just opens a web page on their phone — nothing to download, no app, no accounts. Work through “Before the day” once, in advance, so nothing is a surprise on the day itself.

Written for Windows. **On a Mac**, follow the same steps and read the blue boxes where they appear — everything else is identical.

BEFORE THE DAY **Get it working once, in advance**

1 Download the code

Open this page in your browser:

https://github.com/events26/Fest_26_Onam

Click the green **Code** button near the top right, then **Download ZIP**. You do **not** need a GitHub account or any other program.

2 Unzip it

Find the downloaded file (usually in **Downloads**), right-click it and choose **Extract All...**, then **Extract**. You now have a folder called **Fest_26_Onam-main**. Keep it somewhere easy, like your Desktop.

ON A MAC Just double-click the ZIP — it unpacks itself into the same folder.

3 Install Python

Go to python.org/downloads and click the big yellow **Download Python** button. Run the file it downloads.

This is the one step people get wrong. On the first screen of the installer, tick the box at the bottom that says **“Add python.exe to PATH”** *before* clicking Install Now. If you miss it, nothing later will work, and the error message will not tell you why. If you are unsure, run the installer again and check.

Work laptop that will not let you install anything? You do not need to. There is a portable version of Python that is just a ZIP file — no installer, no admin password, nothing added to Windows. Open **NO-ADMIN-SETUP.txt** in the quiz folder and follow it instead of this step, then carry on at step 4. It takes about three minutes.

ON A MAC There is no PATH box to worry about. Open **Terminal** (press **⌘ Space**, type Terminal, press Enter) and run **python3 --version**. If it prints a version number you are done. If it offers to install developer tools, click **Install** and wait. Otherwise download Python from the same site above.

4 Test it

Open the folder from step 2 and double-click `start-quiz.bat`. A black window should open showing three web addresses.

If it says **Python is not installed**, go back to step 3 — the PATH box was almost certainly missed. Close the window and try again after reinstalling.

ON A MAC Use `start-quiz.command` instead. The **first** time, do not double-click it: **right-click it and choose Open**, then click **Open** again on the warning about an unidentified developer. macOS blocks downloaded scripts otherwise, and a plain double-click just refuses with no way forward. After that first time, double-clicking works normally.

If it still will not open, use Terminal instead: type `cd` (with a space), drag the folder from step 2 into the Terminal window, press Enter, then run `python3 quiz-server.py`.

Leave that window open and go to step 5 to confirm it really works. Closing the window stops the quiz.

5 Allow it through the firewall

Windows will pop up a box asking whether to allow Python to communicate on the network. Click **Allow access**, and make sure **Private networks** is ticked.

If you click **Cancel**, phones will not be able to connect and there will be no other clue what went wrong. If you have already dismissed it, see the troubleshooting table on the next page.

ON A MAC You may get a box asking whether **Python** should accept incoming network connections. Click **Allow**. Many Macs have the firewall switched off and will not ask at all — that is fine, carry on.

6 Check it from a phone

In the black window, find the line starting **Teams join**. It shows an address like

`http://192.168.1.42:8000/` — the numbers will be different on your laptop, so use whatever *your* window shows.

Put one phone on the **same Wi-Fi as the laptop** and type that address into its browser. If the team page loads, you are ready. If not, see troubleshooting.

ON THE DAY Running the quiz

7 Get everyone on one network

The laptop and every phone must be on the **same Wi-Fi**. A hotspot from your own phone is the most reliable choice.

Avoid office, hotel and guest Wi-Fi. These usually stop devices from talking to each other, so phones will never reach the laptop no matter what you do. A personal hotspot avoids the problem completely.

8 Start the quiz

Double-click `start-quiz.bat` again — or `start-quiz.command` on a Mac. Note the **Teams join** address — you will read this out to everyone.

9 Put the big screen up

On the laptop, open `http://localhost:8000/display` in your browser and connect the projector. Then:

- Click **Full screen**
- Click **Turn on sound** — browsers block sound until you click once, so this must be done before the first question

10 Open your own controls

On **your** phone, open the same address as the teams but with `/admin` on the end — for example `http://192.168.1.42:8000/admin` — then sign in.

Ask Sanjay for the username and password before the day. There is no separate quiz password: it is the same login as the main Onam admin page, so you cannot get in without it.

Signing in needs internet, so do it early. Once you are in you stay in, even if the connection drops or the laptop restarts. Keep this page on your own phone — it shows the answers, so do not put it on the projector.

11 Set up the teams

On the admin page, open **Teams & codes**. Change the team names if you need to, then tap **Generate codes** and **Save teams & codes**.

Read each code out to **one person per team**. That phone holds the buzzer for the whole quiz.

12 Let the teams in

Read out the **Teams join** address. Each team opens it, picks their team name and types their code.

Watch the projector: each team's **NOT JOINED** label disappears as they sign in, so you can see who is still missing without asking.

13 Run each question

Read the question aloud from your phone, then tap **Arm buzzers**. Every phone lights up and starts pulsing. Teams tap to buzz. The first one takes the floor and the big screen fills with their colour — and **everyone who buzzes after them lines up behind them**, in the order they tapped. Your phone shows the whole running order:

1	Maveli Squad	0.41s	ANSWERING
2	Gajaveerans	0.63s	
3	Vallam Vikings	0.88s	
4	Onam Kombans	1.12s	

Then:

- **Correct** gives them 10 points and closes the question
- **Wrong — next team** crosses them off and passes the floor straight to number 2, then 3, and so on down the list
- Or **tap any team in the list** to jump straight to them, if you would rather not step through one at a time
- **Show the answer on screen** highlights the right option on the projector
- **Next question**

The buzzers stay open all the way through. A team that hesitated can still tap and join the end of the queue. If everyone who buzzed gets it wrong, the big screen says so and keeps waiting for someone else.

Reset this question starts a question over completely, for when one has to be thrown out.

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The black window says Python was not found	If you installed Python, the Add python.exe to PATH box was missed. Reinstall from python.org/downloads and tick it this time. If you cannot install anything on this laptop, open NO-ADMIN-SETUP.txt in the quiz folder — the portable version needs no installer and no admin rights.
Phones cannot open the page, but the laptop can	Almost always the firewall. Right-click the Start button, choose Terminal (Admin), and paste this in, then press Enter: <pre>New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "Onam Quiz" -LocalPort 8000 -Protocol TCP -Action Allow</pre> If that does not fix it, the Wi-Fi is separating devices — switch to a phone hotspot.
Nothing opens, even on the laptop	The black window is not running, or was closed. Double-click start-quiz.bat again and leave the window open.
Mac: “start-quiz.command cannot be opened because it is from an unidentified developer”	Right-click the file and choose Open , then click Open on the warning. Only needed once. If it still refuses, open Terminal, type cd , drag the folder in, press Enter, then run python3 quiz-server.py .
Mac: the file opens in a text editor instead of running	Its permissions were lost while unzipping. In Terminal, type chmod +x then drag start-quiz.command in and press Enter. Or just run python3 quiz-server.py from the folder.
Mac: phones cannot connect	Open System Settings → Network → Firewall . Either switch it off for the event, or open Options... and set Python to Allow incoming connections .
The address does not work on phones	Check you typed the numbers from <i>your</i> window, including :8000 at the end. Also check the phone is on Wi-Fi and has not quietly switched to mobile data.
Cannot sign in to the admin page	Signing in needs a working internet connection. Check you can load any website on that phone, then try again.
A team's phone died or was locked out	They sign in again with the same code — the newest phone takes over the buzzer. You can also tap Sign out next to their name on the admin page.
The laptop restarted mid-quiz	Nothing is lost. Team names, codes, scores and your sign-in are all saved. Start the launcher again; teams re-open the join page.
Everyone buzzes instantly, just to grab a good place in the order	Give a wrong buzz a penalty. Open quiz-server.py in Notepad, find the line POINTS_WRONG = 0 near the top, change it to POINTS_WRONG = -5 and save. Restart the launcher. Guessing usually stops within one round of the first penalty.

No sound from
the projector

Turn on sound was not clicked on the display page. Move the mouse to make the buttons appear, then click it.

Worth a five-minute rehearsal. Run steps 8 to 13 with two phones the day before. Everything that goes wrong on the day goes wrong in the first two minutes, and it is much easier to fix when there is not a room full of people waiting.